

ered to offer a very natural way to create computer graphics, especially two-dimensional computer graphics. Indeed, many graphics packages (e.g. The GIMP, Corel Painter, Photoshop, Pixel Image editor, Studio Artist and others) are able to make use of the pressure (and, in some cases, stylus tilt or rotation) information generated by a tablet, by modifying the brush size, shape, opacity, colour or other attributes based on data received from the graphics tablet.

In East Asia, graphics tablets, or pen tablets as they are known, are widely used in conjunction with input method editor software (IMEs) to write Chinese, Japanese, Korean (CJK) characters. The technology is popular and inexpensive. This technology enables natural interaction with the computer in a more natural manner, rather than typing on the keyboard.

Tablets are also popular for technical drawings and CAD, as one can put a piece of paper on them without interfering with their function.

Many of the most successful Web comic artists use tablets, including Hawk of Apple Geeks, Jorge Cham of Piled Higher and Deeper, Tim of Ctrl+Alt+Del and Gabe of Penny Arcade, who use graphics tablets to colour directly.

Finally, tablets are gaining popularity as a replacement for the mouse as a pointing device. They are more intuitive to some users than the mouse, as the position of the pen on the tablet typically corresponds to the location of the pointer on the GUI shown on the computer screen. Graphics tablets are available in various sizes and price ranges. A6-sized tablets are relatively inexpensive and A3-sized tablets are comparatively more expensive. Modern tablets usually connect to the computer via a USB interface.

Advocates of tablets and pens cite relief from occupational overuse syndrome varieties such as repetitive strain injury. Sufferers of carpal tunnel syndrome also report good results. This is because the use of computer mice tends to be very repetitive on